

BBHCSD Enhancing Sustainability meeting

February 19th at 6:30 p.m. at the High School Media Center

Notes below include a summary of all points suggested as possibilities for future district actions and initiatives relating to environmental sustainability.

(*) indicates high frequency suggestion

Energy and Emissions

Energy Efficiency

- Lighting
 - Sensors (motion sensors/vacancy sensors) *
 - Energy efficient lighting – LEDs *
 - Switch off unused lighting
 - Utilize natural lighting
 - Reduced lighting in too bright areas
 - Control systems
- HVAC
 - Better temperature moderation (too cold in summer and too hot in winter)
 - Energy efficient mechanical equipment upgrades
 - Control systems
- Electronics
 - Turn off computers/electronics overnight and on weekends/holidays (offices/comp labs)
 - Power management software and sleep settings enabled on computers
 - EnergyStar certified equipment purchases

Renewable Energy

- Solar panels on school buildings (roofs, carports or sheltered entrance) *
- Wind turbines on school buildings

Grounds and Landscapes

Landscape Management

- Dedicated nature space at new campus
- Identify existing vegetation at current schools
- Coordinate plantings with city arborist
- Plant trees at all buildings and replace dead/removed trees
- Native plants at the new school
- Avoid Round-up and neonicotinoids
- Partner with Cleveland Seed Bank (currently working with Highland)
- Gardens with produce to be used in school lunches

Stormwater Management

- Rain barrels
- Permeable pavement
- Bioswales in new parking lot

Buildings and Operations

Buildings

- Bird safe glass on windows
- Building envelope improvements and insulation
- Roofing improvements

Water Conservation

- Touchless faucets
- WaterSense certified low flow efficient water fixtures

Indoor air quality

- No sharpies (strong/unhealthy odor)
- Green Seal Certified cleaning products
- No VOC paint and adhesives

Food and Dining

- Use real silverware and durable lunch trays that can be washed *
- Zero Waste lunch challenges
- Microwave and bottle filling stations for lunch packers
- Eliminate straws
- Reduce waste and single use plastics *
- Compost food waste *
 - Rust Belt Riders collection service
 - Compost on school grounds (at all schools) and use for district landscaping
 - Compost projects for students (collection and student research projects)
- Snack bag recycling
- Reduce food waste
- Donate leftover food from lunches
- Create “share tables” to offer food that is purchased but not consumed
- Local food when possible

Education and Engagement

Curriculum

- Expand nature topics in curriculum
- Run pledge campaigns to commit to avoiding single use plastics
- NEORSD stormwater education for credits/reduced fees on sewer bill
- Make environmental studies a required course in the district
- Sustainability throughout K-12 curriculum
- Create outdoor lab/education space at schools
- Educate on scale of climate problem – 10 years to make changes/avoid worst climate impacts
- Less time on Chromebooks (better for learning and saves electricity)

Parent Outreach/Engagement

- Educate parents and involve them in improvements
- Address culture of waste
- Incentive programs for sustainable living
- Signage on recycling/sustainability initiatives to make students/parents aware

Purchasing and Waste/Recycling

Procurement

- Buy recycled content paper
- Use less paper / reduce printing / double sided printing
- Purchase quality building/classroom materials upfront = less repair/replacement/waste
- Tablets or white boards for elementary school printing

Waste Management and Recycling

- Reduce first, then recycle
- Better recycling facilities, more recycling bins, recycling education *
- Involve custodial staff and students
- Battery recycling
- Recycle markers (Crayola or Terracycle examples)
- Exchange programs to reduce waste and need to buy new
 - End of year school supply exchange
 - Pencils for Pupils (reuse leftover writing utensils)
 - Sports equipment exchange
 - Clothing exchange
 - Toy exchange
- Single use plastic art in front of school/fieldhouse (Sandusky example)
- More filtered water stations to reduce plastic (esp Middle School)

Transportation

- Encourage walking/biking to school
- Help set up carpools
- Create carpooling platform for extracurricular activities (explore Gohio Commute)
- Neighborhood transportation board for ride sharing
- No idling signage (private cars and buses)

Coordination and Planning

- Draft district environmental mission statement with principles, goals, objectives
- Students draft mission statement for clubs

Funding

- Grant writing to get environmental initiatives implemented
- Write grants for recycle education
- Hire a grant writer
- Document savings and reinvest into further environmental initiatives

Useful Resources:

[Green Schools Alliance](#)

[Cuyahoga County Climate Action Plan](#)